

MATHEW SCHUMER

DATA JOURNALIST

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Hamburg, Deutschland

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Journalist, The Baltimore Sun

Apr 2025 - Apr 2026

- I worked on breaking news coverage and in-depth reporting with public-facing data, as well as documents and data obtained through freedom of information laws.
- I used programs like R Studio and Python to parse this data and visualization software such as Flourish and Datawrapper to illustrate it.
- My investigative stories ranged from explorations of traffic-related injuries and traffic violation data, to exposing a decline in emergency responders' use of Baltimore's crisis response system.

Freelance Journalist, The Washington City Paper

Aug 2023 - Apr 2025

- As a regular contributor to The Washington City Paper, I covered crime and police accountability in D.C., and completed investigative pieces utilizing crime data and FOIA.
- Alongside my data work, I also dug through court records and interviewed numerous sources to shed light on ongoing police brutality and misconduct in D.C.

Reporting Intern, OpenSecrets

Aug 2023 - Jan 2024

- My work at OpenSecrets involved researching and writing about campaign finance, lobbying, and expenditure reports.
- I completed extensive data analysis on political spending of special interest groups, in addition to candidates and their respective committees.

Freelance Journalist

Aug 2022 - Present

- Local reporting bylines in The 51st, The Baltimore Fishbowl, The Newtown Bee and more.
- National and international reportage for Inkstick, Truthout and others.

EDUCATION

Master's Degree in Journalism

Aug 2022 - May 2024

University of Maryland, College Park

- Received a Master's Degree in Journalism at UMD's Philip Merrill College.
- Served as a graduate assistant at UMD McKeldin Library, researching a project in collaboration with The White House Correspondents Association and The Merrill Foundation.

Bachelor's Degree in Journalism

Aug 2018 - May 2012

Western Connecticut State University

- Received a Bachelor's Degree in Journalism. Worked as General Manager and Program Director of WCSU's student-run radio station, WXCI 91.7fm.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Reporting

Writing

HTML/CSS

Data Visualization

Python

R Studio

Freedom of Information

News Photography

Fact-Checking

AWARDS

Spotlight DC Fund for Investigative Journalism

I received a grant in 2025 to investigate DC's use of surveillance technology to locate gunshots, and how that technology disproportionately deployed law enforcement in communities of color.

Association of Alternative Newsmedia AAN Award Finalist

In May 2026, I was selected as a finalist for the AAN's award for Beat Reporting for my police accountability coverage for the Washington City Paper.